

3.5 Functions in JavaScript

We took a cursory look at what functions are at the beginning of this chapter—let’s take the more specific context of functions in JavaScript.

Writing a function

Writing a JavaScript function is hardly different from writing any old block of code—only this time, you’ll be enclosing them in curly braces and giving them names. Once you’ve written a function, you can make it execute at any time just by calling it by name.

Functions are best written within the `<head>` tags of your HTML document, so that they load before the document is rendered in the browser. Let’s write a function that tells a visitor which browser he or she is using.

```
<html>
<head>
<script>
function checkBrowser()
{
  var browser = navigator.appName
  alert("You are using "+browser)
}
</script>
</head>
<body>

  <input type="button" value="Check Browser!"
onclick="checkBrowser()">
</body>
</html>
```

The statement `“onclick=“checkBrowser()”` tells the browser to execute the `“checkBrowser”` function when the button is clicked. `“onclick”` is an *event* associated with the button—we’ll get to events later in this chapter. You can also have functions that accept *argu-*